The Markdown Prompt Toolkit

6 symbols that change how AI thinks

You are not just writing prompts. You are programming the shape of the response.

When you use Markdown **with purpose** in a prompt, you communicate at two levels: what you want, and how you want the AI to think about it. That second level is **meta-communication**, and most people never use it.

`**bold**` Bold

SIGNALS TO AI

This is a priority, constraint, or key term. Weight it more heavily.

`# Header` Heading

SIGNALS TO AI

New context or section begins here. Scope your response accordingly.

`- item` Bullet List

SIGNALS TO AI

Give me discrete, parallel, separate items. Not flowing prose.

`1. item` Numbered List

SIGNALS TO AI

Order matters here. Give me sequence, steps, or ranked output.

```` ```code``` ```` Code Block

SIGNALS TO AI

Switch to precise, literal mode. Exact syntax matters here.

`> quote` Blockquote

SIGNALS TO AI

This is the text I want you to analyze, reference, or respond to.

SEE THE DIFFERENCE

WITHOUT STRUCTURE

```
Can you review my code and tell
me what's wrong and suggest
improvements and check for
security issues?
```

WITH PURPOSEFUL MARKDOWN

```
**Review my code:**
1. Bugs and errors
2. Suggested improvements
3. Security issues
```


Structure is not decoration. It is instruction.